Questions and Answers

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

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Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***Could Jesus have sinned?***
   How did Jesus face every temptation that we have if not everything was the same (for example scrolling endlessly online because there we're no phones or lust because he didn't have a girlfriend/wife)?
   Key Passage:
   a. Hebrews 4:15 – "For we have not an high priest which cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities; but was in all points tempted like as we are, yet without sin."
      i. Jesus COULD have sinned- He was fully God and fully man. He had to be given a genuine choice to understand our temptations, humanity, and to be able to be the spotless lamb of our salvation
         1. This is one of the things that makes our God so much greater than any other God; he became one of us, he understands: pain, sorrow, hurt, exhaustion, work, etc.... he was the God-Man.
      ii. The Devil knew this and wanted to exploit it at Jesus weakest moment in his human form- Matt. 4:1-11
   b. Jesus may have lived at a different time than us, but the Bible is clear about temptations and the **root** of them ALL- 1 John 2:16
      i. **ALL** that is in the world
      ii. The tactics of temptation are technically different in the exact avenues he uses, but the root temptations are the same from the beginning- Gen. 3:6
         1. All three temptations are seen in the very beginning, and they are seen today
2. ***Is there any biblical evidence connecting the flood in Genesis to the scientific theory of Pangaea/The Continental Split?***
   a. This idea comes from Genesis 1:9-10; Genesis 10:25; and 1 Chron. 1:19
   b. Some other evidence to support this idea would be:
      i. Genesis 7:11- The tectonic plates **broken**
         1. Research has revealed that enormous quantities of water are stored deep within the Earth's mantle, primarily within a mineral called **ringwoodite**. This mineral, located approximately 400 miles beneath the surface, can trap water within its crystal structure. Studies suggest that the amount of water contained in ringwoodite could be **three times the volume of all Earth's surface oceans combined**. **Study Reference:** A 2014 study published in *Science* provided seismic evidence supporting the presence of water-rich ringwoodite in the Earth's transition zone.
         2. Some would say that the deep referred to here is the sea of glass, however, it seems clear that these are "fountains" under the ocean that were broken up. These fountains have since been found.
            a. Also the "deep" shows up in the Bible 65x:
               i. It refers to the deep as a prison/hell/maybe the bottomless pit 3x
               ii. It refers to the deep 8x very obscurely (even of these, it is associated with water/seas 6 of those 8 times)
               iii. It refers to the general use of the word deep 33x (a deep pit, a deep well, etc.)

iv. It refers to the oceans/seas specifically on the earth 21x as the deep

3. Fossils- Found to match at coastlines across the ocean
4. Geological- Matching mountain ranges such as the Appalachian and Caledonian Mountains in Scotland and Scandinavia
5. Fit of Continents- The coastlines of continents such as South America and Africa seem to fit together like puzzle pieces

c. Other thoughts
   i. God uses the same "**divided**" language in Deut. 32:7-8
   ii. A practical view of this idea- It would seem to reason that such cataclysmic event as the actual plates of the earth shifting hundreds/thousands of miles would be found in history somewhere. We are not explicitly told this is the Bible and so we cannot be sure of it. And we are not told this from any history, so we don't have that evidence either.
      1. Also, the smallest of shifts of tectonic plates causes massive earthquakes and tsunamis. We don't want to take any "God-factor" out of it, but reasonably, this would have likely killed many or even everyone living
   iii. A more plausible explanation
      1. The GREAT flood and total destruction of the earth during the gap is a very plausible place/time for this to have happened- Genesis 1:1-2; Jeremiah 4:23-27
      2. The Gap- Genesis 1:1-2
         a. We see in Genesis 1:1-2 a clear gap in time (not uncommon, there are gaps in between commas that span thousands of years in the Bible)- Isa. 9:6-7; 61:1-3; Dan. 9:26-27; Zech. 9:9-10; Luke 1:31-32
         b. The presence of **Darkness**- 1 John 1:5; Rev. 21:23
         c. Fall of Lucifer- Ezek. 28; Isa. 14
         d. Replenish- Gen. 1:28; Gen 9:1 (both first usages after a flood)
         e. Created Vs. Made- Gen. 1:1, 27 ---- 1:7, 16, 25, 31---- Gen. 2:3
         f. Heaven/Heavens- If Gen. 1:1-2 was a preliminary statement on the entirety of creation, God would have said in vs. 1 "heavens" not heaven. They became "heavens" as he separated them during creation
         g. God does not create in **vain**- Isa. 45:18
         h. Paul's comparison- 2 Cor. 4:6- Paul compares how the gospel shined into our hearts with Christ to how God introduced light into darkness at creation
         i. Psalm 104:30- A look back at Gen. 1:1-2; the spirit was Renewing the face of the earth
         j. Job 38:4,7- The angels were there at the foundation (very beginning) of the earth; not created on days 1-3 when the earth was already there. They were rejoicing at the earths creation
      3. This was the destruction of the **whole world** and included the heavens; NOT Noah's flood- 2 Pet. 3:5-7
         a. The way that God describes this destruction is different than Noah's flood, the whole world was destroyed, the heavens affected, it was an "old earth" not even the same at all
         b. Also the context was vs. 4 "all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation". They are referring to the creation, not the time of Noah
      4. During the destruction of the earth when Lucifer fell would be a plausible time that this kind of plate shifting, mountain moving, land dividing could have happened. When God remakes the world, the earth is already there underneath the water, all he does is move the water for the land to appear- Gen. 1:9

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH
WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***Could Jesus have sinned?***
   How did Jesus face every temptation that we have if not everything was the same (for example scrolling endlessly online because there we're no phones or lust because he didn't have a girlfriend/wife)?
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         1. This is one of the things that makes our God so much greater than any other God; he became one of us, he understands: pain, sorrow, hurt, exhaustion, work, etc…. he was the God-Man.
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1. ***Without Judas' betrayal, Jesus wouldn't have been crucified and then people wouldn't be saved. was Judas always doomed to betray Jesus? Was that always part of Gods plan or did God have a different plan?***
    a. To answer this question, we must first examine who Judas was:
        i. He was called a **devil**- John 6:70- *Jesus answered them, Have not I chosen you twelve, and one of you is a devil?*
        ii. He was indwelt by Satan at one point- Luke 22:3- *Then entered Satan into Judas surnamed Iscariot…* ALSO IN John 13:27- *And after the sop Satan entered into him. Then said Jesus unto him, That thou doest, do quickly.*
        iii. He is the **antichrist**
            1. He was called the son of perdition, the only other one that title is used for is the antichrist- John 17:12; 2 Thess. 2:3
            2. He went "to his own place"- Acts 1:25; Rev. 17:8
        iv. He is very possibly the actual offspring of Satan
            1. In Acts 1:16-20 Peter refers to a passage in Psalms as being about Judas and his betrayal- Psalm 109:8-15
            2. Also, nobody else is called "a devil" but Judas. He was not "possessed" with a devil, but was "a devil"
        v. Prophesies of his betrayal
            1. Psalm 41:9 and John 13:18
            2. Zechariah 11:12-13 and Matthew 26:14-15; 27:3-10
            3. Psalm 109:6-8 and Acts 1:20
    b. The Verdict
        i. God in his omniscience absolutely foreknew that Judas would betray Jesus, but that does not mean that he MADE him
            1. God knows all things and therefore he can prophesy anything he wants; for him to be accused of MAKING people do things, just because he says he knows what will happen, is not reasonable
        ii. Even in the case of Judas: a devil, the antichrist, and possible child of Satan; he had a choice to make; he could have chosen anything he wanted
            1. We see fallen angels seemingly given space to repent in the Bible- Psalm 82
        iii. Judas is as close to an exception to the rule of choice as you can get, but even in his case, I would say that he was still given a genuine choice and he chose to betray Christ
2. ***What is the difference between a biblical view of free will and a Calvinist's view of free will?***
    a. A Calvinists view of free will
        i. **Compatibilism**- You choose freely—but **only** what your heart wants—and God controls what your heart wants- John 6:37,44
            1. Imagine a lion. You put a bowl of lettuce and a steak in front of it. The lion "freely" chooses the steak every time—not because it's forced, but because that's its nature.
            2. It is not just that you will always want to choose evil because of your sinful nature, but that you are only CAPABLE of choosing evil because of your sinful nature. (it is impossible for the lion to not eat the steak)
            3. This is where their idea of Total Depravity Comes in. You are so totally depraved in your sin that God must first save you and then you believe

4. Calvinism says that God chose before the foundation of the world those who he would draw to himself to be saved. Only those who he would draw could be saved and this was already determined before the world began. You can dress it up and make it look Christian, but this leaves no room for evangelism, prayer for the lost, discipleship, etc.. it was ALREADY DETERMINED. To live otherwise is a lie.
5. video

b. A Biblical view of free will
   i. **Libertarian Free Will**- You have the genuine ability to choose between two or more possible options—and **nothing**, not even God, predetermines your choices in such a way that you *must* choose one over the other.
   ii. Biblical support of this idea and against Calvinists view- Deut. 30:19; Josh. 24:15; Isa. 1:18-20; John 3:16; John 1:12; Eph. 1:13; Acts 7:51; 2 Pet. 3:9; Rom. 10:13; Eze. 18:21, 23, 32
   iii. God draws ALL men to himself, not all answer the call- John 12:32; Titus 2:11
      1. **The Master Chess Player Illustration**
         a. Imagine God is a **chess grandmaster** playing against a free-willed human being.
         b. The human player is completely free to make **any move** he wants on the chessboard—good moves, bad moves, smart moves, foolish moves.
         c. God **never forces** him to make a certain move. He lets the man play freely.
         d. **But**, because God is infinitely wise and sees the end from the beginning, **He always responds** to each move in a way that keeps His ultimate victory certain.
         e. No matter what the man does—aggressive move, trick play, or foolish blunder—God already knows how to counter it and still bring the game to His intended outcome. **The freedom of the human player never threatens the outcome** of the game.
         f. **Key Point**: God doesn't need to control every move. He is so much more powerful than that. (That is called rigging the game). He knows the end from the beginning, he knows all things, he can counter any move made to still get to the end he desires.

3. Does God have favorites since the Israelites are "his people"?

   i. This goes into more ideas that relate to Calvinism or the idea of God "randomly selecting" those he would love/prefer vs those he would hate/condemn

b. **Predestination/Election**- Election refers to God's selection of a group or body of people for a purpose—usually to represent Him on earth and to carry His message—not to exclusive salvation. Election in Scripture is often corporate, functional, and missional, not individualistic.
   i. Pre (before) destination (where you are going)- God's plan from the past for his people/children and what he wants them to do on this earth.

c. God elected to use Abraham and his lineage as a representative group to go and bless **all** the earth- Gen. 12:1-3
   1. Abraham could have rejected this offer, he is the example of faith for us today because he believed and obeyed God when he called. Who knows how many were asked before Abraham or would have been asked after him.
   2. God wanted a vessel that would obey him, through which he could reach the world. That is what he predestinates. He elects the group through which this is to be done, NEVER INDIVIDUAL SALVATION
   ii. Israel was called to be:
      1. Holy- Exo. 19:5-6
      2. Representatives to bring the whole world to God- Isa. 42:6; Isa. 55:6-7
   iii. We today are called to be:
      1. Holy- Eph. 1:4-5
      2. Representatives to bring the whole world to God- 1 Pet. 2:9

d. Election is not about exclusivity into God's "special chosen club". It is about God picking a vehicle through which to bring the entire **world** to himself (his ultimate goal/destiny for the world)

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iii. God draws ALL men to himself, not all answer the call- John 12:32; Titus 2:11

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3. Does God have favorites since the Israelites are "his people"?

a. **Predestination/Election**- Election refers to God's selection of a group or body of people for a purpose—usually to represent Him on earth and to carry His message—not to exclusive salvation. Election in Scripture is often corporate, functional, and missional, not individualistic.

b. God elected to use Abraham and his lineage as a representative group to go and bless _____the earth- Gen. 12:1-3

i. Israel was called to be:

1. Holy- Exo. 19:5-6
2. Representatives to bring the whole world to God- Isa. 42:6; Isa. 55:6-7

ii. We today are called to be:

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1. ***What are the Dead Sea scrolls and why do people use them? And are they credible?***
    a. The Dead Sea scrolls are a collection of over 950 ancient Jewish manuscripts, discovered between 1947 and 1956 in eleven caves near Qumran, on the northwestern shore of the Dead Sea in modern-day Israel. These texts were written primarily on parchment and papyrus, and are dated from 250 B.C. to A.D. 68. The scrolls are attributed to a Jewish sect, widely believed by most to be the Essenes, who lived in the Qumran settlement during the Second Temple period.
        i. **Biblical Manuscripts**: Over 230 manuscripts represent portions of every Old Testament book except Esther, comprising approximately 25% of the total finds. The most represented books include: **Psalms** – 39 manuscripts; **Deuteronomy** – 33 manuscripts; **Isaiah** – 22 manuscripts (including the nearly complete Great Isaiah Scroll, 1QIsaa)
        ii. When these were discovered, they were the oldest existing manuscripts of the old testament that had been found to date. This was a major discovery since it allowed everyone to see if the existing manuscripts we had and also the translations that came from them, were accurate
        iii. For us who believe by faith the word of God, and have faith that God will preserve his word, this was not a discovery that changed anything really. We believed by faith that God would preserve and purify his word through time. This merely helped to confirm what we already believed to be true
    b. At first glance, many "so called scholars" were enabled to look through fragments of these manuscripts and immediately concluded that they proved the "Septuagint" was the older and more original text; however, over the years that passed, as more people were given access to them, all manuscripts have been thoroughly studied, and **new evidence**/technologies have come to light, and here is what has been found- CHART
        i. In fact, in the greatest manuscript (1QIsaiahA/ The Great Isaiah Scroll) amongst what is considered the greatest archeological find of the 21st century, it aligns with the Masoretic text 95% of the time! (exact mss used for your kjv)
        ii. What about the other 5%?- There was another archeological find in 1993, the Tel Dan Stele, which talks about the "House of David". It was found in Israel and dates back to the 9th century BC! Only about 100-200 years after David lived!
            1. The oldest archaeological inscription mentioning David—the **Tel Dan Stele**—spells the name **DWD** (דוד), which is a consonantal spelling without vowels, dating to the **9th century BCE**.
            2. The **Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa^a)** from around 150 BCE **uses a later spelling**, **DWYD** (דויד), inserting a **yod** to function like a vowel.
            3. The **Masoretic Text**, although copied in the **Middle Ages**, preserves the **older form** (DWD), the same as the Tel Dan inscription. In that sense, the MT retains the *more ancient textual form*.

4. This shows us that the Masoretes kept the OT down to the very letters exactly as it was originally written and copied! That 5% variance is where the dead sea scrolls are off, not the Masoretic text!

c. What does this all mean?
   i. The Dead Sea scrolls were a great archeological discovery, that did not change **anything** we believed about God's word, his preserving of it, his purifying of it, etc.. But only confirmed that which we already knew based on Romans 3:2
      1. God's word was kept by HIS people, in Hebrew, not Greek, down to the very letters and symbols!- Matt. 5:18; Psa. 12:6-7
      2. It also confirms the the Bible is not a "game of telephone" translation of a translation of a translation of a translation, etc…as some critics say

2. Some people say that we won't know each other in heaven, is that true?

a. Key Verse: **Acts 3:20–21-** *And he shall send Jesus Christ, which before was preached unto you: Whom the heaven must receive until the times of restitution of all things, which God hath spoken by the mouth of all his holy prophets since the world began.*

b. A major theme of the Bible from the very beginning, has been God's ultimate plan to redeem and **restore** all things to their original, perfect, sinless state. To examine God's plan for the future/heaven, we can observe the past.
   i. Genesis 3:6-13- The original relationship of man, woman, and God
      1. Adam and Eve had a relationship- vs 6; 1:28
      2. Adam and Eve both had a relationship to God- vs 8-9
         a. Adam and God talk- vs 9-12
         b. Eve and God talk- vs 13
         c. They seemed to have an appointed time each day of conversation and fellowship- vs 8
         d. They not only had a "general" relationship, but a specific relationship where they talked by name

c. Our God is a God of personal relationships- Exo. 33:11; Psa. 139:1-4; Isa. 43:1-2; John 10:14-15; 15:15; Jer. 24:7; Eze 36:28; SOS 2:16; 6:3; 7:10; 8:6-7

d. We see specific examples of personal knowledge of others in the future and a personal relationship with them- Matt. 8:11; Luke 16:23-25; Rev 21:3; 1 Cor. 13:12

e. I believe that this teaching comes from "religion"
   i. Some people who are well meaning have heard, been taught, or been convinced of thinking certain cold and religious views. These often stem simply from a misrepresentation of God and his character! I believe that is where this idea comes from.

3. I know that drinking is wrong but where does it say in the Bible?

a. First mention of alcohol- Gen. 9:20-21
   i. It is almost exclusively used in a negative context in the Bible- Gen. 19:30-38

b. Abstaining from drinking alcohol is over and over again shown as a mark of a more **mature** follower of God:
   i. **Leviticus 10:9** – Priests forbidden to drink when ministering
   ii. **Numbers 6:3** – Nazarites abstain totally from the vine
   iii. **Daniel 1:8** – Daniel refused Babylon's wine
   iv. **1 Timothy 3:3, Titus 1:7** – Bishops and elders not to be given to wine
   v. **Proverbs 31:4** – Kings and leaders are warned not to drink
      1. If you want to consume alcohol, you have liberty to do that. The Bible unquestionably gives you liberty to do anything you want BUT NOT ALL THINGS WILL EDIFY YOU, especially what brings you under its power (1 Cor. 6:12; 10:23)

a. Notice who God says this to! The carnal, immature church who was more concerned with "what they can technically do/get away with" than glorifying God to the max!

c. Final Thoughts
   i. People will find reasons to drink if they want to drink
      1. "Jesus turned water to wine/Jesus drank"- John 2:1-11
         a. The word *wine* can refer to **grape juice or fermented wine**, so the context matters.
         b. Jesus created **135 gallons** of wine. If it were alcoholic, it would be enough to make an entire town drunk, violating *Habakkuk 2:15* ("Woe unto him that giveth his neighbour drink…")
         c. If Jesus himself drank, he violated the word of God in Lev. 10:10-11 and Proverbs 31:4; as the High Priest and the King of Kings
      2. "It is technically allowed for medical purposes and for those struggling mentally/emotionally"- 1 Tim. 5:23; Prov. 31:6
         a. If you are looking for reasons to drink, you can make these fit your life at any given time. There are many other solutions to these issues besides self-medicating with alcohol!
         b. At the end of the day God could not/did not absolutely 100% forbid alcohol for two reasons:
            i. It was necessary for some medically at this time in history since little/no other options were available for medication.
            ii. As a stumbling block to those who are seeking to live in their flesh and not actually follow God at all costs, to the maximum extant possible.
            iii. He gave enough warnings and clues about it biblically that you would understand, a mature Christian who seeks God's glory and to serve him above all else would not partake of alcohol. – John 6
            iv. Eph 5:18- And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;
   ii. At the end of the discussion/debate on this subject, this is the absolute best you can say about alcohol consumption: IT IS FOR FOOLS AND IT IS SIN- Prov. 20:1; 24:9; Psa. 69:5; Num. 12:11

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***What are the Dead Sea scrolls and why do people use them? And are they credible?***
    a. The Dead Sea scrolls are a collection of over 950 ancient Jewish manuscripts, discovered between 1947 and 1956 in eleven caves near Qumran, on the northwestern shore of the Dead Sea in modern-day Israel. These texts were written primarily on parchment and papyrus, and are dated from 250 B.C. to A.D. 68. The scrolls are attributed to a Jewish sect, widely believed by most to be the Essenes, who lived in the Qumran settlement during the Second Temple period.
        i. **Biblical Manuscripts**: Over 230 manuscripts represent portions of every Old Testament book except Esther, comprising approximately 25% of the total finds. The most represented books include: **Psalms** – 39 manuscripts; **Deuteronomy** – 33 manuscripts; **Isaiah** – 22 manuscripts (including the nearly complete Great Isaiah Scroll, 1QIsaa)
    b. At first glance, many "so called scholars" were enabled to look through fragments of these manuscripts and immediately concluded that they proved the "Septuagint" was the older and more original text; however, over the years that passed, as more people were given access to them, all manuscripts have been thoroughly studied, and _____ _____/technologies have come to light, and here is what has been found- CHART
        i. What about the other 5%?- There was another archeological find in 1993, the Tel Dan Stele, which talks about the "House of David". It was found in Israel and dates back to the 9th century BC! Only about 100-200 years after David lived!
    c. What does this all mean?
        i. The Dead Sea scrolls were a great archeological discovery, that did not change _____we believed about God's word, his preserving of it, his purifying of it, etc.. But only confirmed that which we already knew based on Romans 3:2
            1. God's word was kept by HIS people, in Hebrew, not Greek, down to the very letters and symbols!- Matt. 5:18; Psa. 12:6-7
            2. It also confirms the the Bible is not a "game of telephone" translation of a translation of a translation of a translation, etc…as some critics say
2. ***Some people say that we won't know each other in heaven, is that true?***
    a. Key Verse: **Acts 3:20–21-** *And he shall send Jesus Christ, which before was preached unto you: Whom the heaven must receive until the times of restitution of all things, which God hath spoken by the mouth of all his holy prophets since the world began.*
    b. A major theme of the Bible from the very beginning, has been God's ultimate plan to redeem and _____all things to their original, perfect, sinless state. To examine God's plan for the future/heaven, we can observe the past.
        i. Genesis 3:6-13- The original relationship of man, woman, and God
            1. Adam and Eve had a relationship- vs 6; 1:28
            2. Adam and Eve both had a relationship to God- vs 8-9
                a. Adam and God talk- vs 9-12
                b. Eve and God talk- vs 13
                c. They seemed to have an appointed time each day of conversation and fellowship- vs 8

d. They not only had a “general” relationship, but a specific relationship where they talked <u>by name</u>

c. Our God is a God of personal relationships- Exo. 33:11; Psa. 139:1-4; Isa. 43:1-2; John 10:14-15; 15:15; Jer. 24:7; Eze 36:28; SOS 2:16; 6:3; 7:10; 8:6-7

d. We see specific examples of personal knowledge of others in the future and a personal relationship with them- Matt. 8:11; Luke 16:23-25; Rev 21:3; 1 Cor. 13:12

e. I believe that this teaching comes from “religion”

3. I know that drinking is wrong but where does it say in the Bible?

a. First mention of alcohol- Gen. 9:20-21
   i. It is almost exclusively used in a negative context in the Bible- Gen. 19:30-38

b. Abstaining from drinking alcohol is over and over again shown as a mark of a more _____ follower of God:
   i. **Leviticus 10:9** – Priests forbidden to drink when ministering
   ii. **Numbers 6:3** – Nazarites abstain totally from the vine
   iii. **Daniel 1:8** – Daniel refused Babylon’s wine
   iv. **1 Timothy 3:3, Titus 1:7** – Bishops and elders not to be given to wine
   v. **Proverbs 31:4** – Kings and leaders are warned not to drink
      1. If you want to consume alcohol, you have liberty to do that. The Bible unquestionably gives you liberty to do anything you want BUT NOT ALL THINGS WILL EDIFY YOU, especially what brings you under its power (1 Cor. 6:12; 10:23)

c. Final Thoughts
   i. People will find reasons to drink if they want to drink
      1. “Jesus turned water to wine/Jesus drank”- John 2:1-11
         a. The word *wine* can refer to **grape juice or fermented wine**, so the context matters.
         b. Jesus created **135 gallons** of wine. If it were alcoholic, it would be enough to make an entire town drunk, violating *Habakkuk 2:15* (“Woe unto him that giveth his neighbour drink…”)
         c. If Jesus himself drank, he violated the word of God in Lev. 10:10-11 and Proverbs 31:4; as the High Priest and the King of Kings
      2. “It is technically allowed for medical purposes and for those struggling mentally/emotionally”- 1 Tim. 5:23; Prov. 31:6
   ii. At the end of the discussion/debate on this subject, this is the absolute best you can say about alcohol consumption: IT IS FOR FOOLS AND IT IS SIN- Prov. 20:1; 24:9; Psa. 69:5; Num. 12:11

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***Who are the beasts in Revelation chapter 4? Seraphim or Cherubim? Do they represent anything?***
    a. To answer this question, we will work this out together, comparing scripture with scripture, not changing, reading into, or altering at all what any of the passages SAY. The conclusion we come to will be based on what the bible ALONE states
        i. Revelation 4:6-8- ***4 Beasts***
        ii. Ezekiel 1:3-28; 10:1-22- ***Cherubim***
        iii. Isaiah 6:1-3- ***Seraphim***
    b. What is clung onto by those who want to believe that these are cherubim:
        i. Pictures, types, shadows, or **vague** descriptions of Cherubim mentioned elsewhere
            1. OT ark of the covenant; only 2 cherubim and they only have 2 wings, not the same description we see elsewhere
            2. OT references to God dwelling "between the cherubim" (2 Sam. 19:15; Psa. 80:1; 99:1; etc..)
                a. We believe exactly what these passages teach about him dwelling between the cherubim, however, we understand it based on the CLEAR, SPECIFIC, DETAILED passages where we are shown the throne of God in visions/revelations from God (Ezekiel, Isaiah, Revelation). Not the other way around (violating the CLARITY FACTOR)
        ii. The animals mentioned in Ezekiel and Revelation (Lion, Ox, Cherub, Man, Eagle)
            1. This is where the similarities between the two end
            2. It is the differences that make the difference

	Water	Methanol
Appearance	Clear, colorless liquid	Clear, colorless liquid
Effect	Sustains life, hydrates the body	Causes blindness, organ failure, and death
Smell/Taste	No smell, no taste	Slight alcohol-like smell, but hard to detect
Toxicity	Safe to drink	As little as a few tablespoons can kill an adult

                a. Just because 1 thing about them is mentioned in both places does not make them the same
        iii. "Seraphim are only mentioned one time in the Bible"
            1. This is used to say that we cannot say they are seraphim because they are only mentioned one other time in the bible (we cannot base a doctrine on a single verse)
            2. First, this is not true. They are talked about in Isaiah 6 and Revelation 4 based on the connections God makes in his word
            3. Second; the idea that the beasts in revelation 4 are cherubim is based on ZERO other scripture references
                a. You will never be able to find a mention of Cherub or Cherubim with any description of them that matches up with the description of the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.

b. In order to try to make the four beasts in Revelation chapter four Cherubim you will have to assume that either John or Ezekiel saw and then wrote their description incorrectly under the inspiration of the Holy Ghost and it was preserved for us this way (incorrectly, no matter what you "say" that is what this would mean). Some people have a problem with this statement but it is simply true. You cannot approach the Revelation given to John or the vision given to Ezekiel assuming that every thing they wrote was correct as pertaining to what is actually in heaven if you think that both are Cherubim. There is an absolute truth of what is in heaven. That is if you were to ask God to give you a description of Cherubim or Seraphim or the four beasts, there is the absolute truth of what they actually look like in reality. You cannot assume that Ezekiel and John got that absolute truth correct and say that the Cherubim are the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.

iv. "Ezekiel saw them when they were carrying the throne of God down from heaven and so he saw the 4 wings and the other 2 were flying/carrying the throne" ALSO "John was standing in heaven stationary, while Ezekiel saw them flying and moving, hence why John only saw one face and Ezekiel saw all of them"

1. This is a dangerous way of reading the bible, and it assumes that John/Ezekiel saw and recorded God's revelation to them incorrectly- Ezekiel 1:1; Rev. 4:1-2
2. We know that this is not how we are to read the bible, especially when God connects the dots for us and shows us exactly who matches the same description in Isaiah 6 (Holy, holy, holy; wings, face: CONSISTENCY FACTOR, COMPARING SCRIPTURE WITH SCRIPTURE FACTOR)
3. ALSO- Ezekiel 1:11, 23
    a. Almost as if God saw this coming, he makes sure to specify to everyone exactly how many of each wings do what job. He breaks it down into 2 and 2, 2 times!
    b. Also notice, Ezekiel does not say he "perceived" or "saw" that they had 4 wings and 4 faces, he says "THEY HAD" emphatically! An absolute statement of truth, not a perception or observation

v. Why does this **matter**?- 2 Pet. 1:20

1. Ultimately, this issue does not change much for us doctrinally, however, as with anything we come across in the Bible, we want to know and believe what God says about it, period.
2. A few rules of Bible study that are violated to "make it fit" the belief many have that these are cherubim:
    a. Every word/event factor
    b. Comparing scripture factor
    c. Consistency factor
    d. Literal factor
    e. Clarity factor

c. What do they represent?

i. It has been said that the beasts represent all of creation and also different aspects of Jesus Christ, that they align with the gospels:

1. Matthew- Jesus as King (Lion)
2. Mark- Jesus as servant (Ox/calf)
3. Luke- Jesus as man (man)
4. John- Jesus as God (eagle)

2. ***Who are the 24 elders in Revelation?***
    a. The elders are:
        i. **Wearing white raiment**- Rev. 4:4 WITH Rev. 3:5, 18; Isa. 61:10
        ii. **Wearing crowns**- Rev. 4:4 WITH 2 Tim. 4:8; James 1:12; 1 Pet. 5:4; 1 Cor. 9:25
        iii. **Sat on seats/thrones**- Rev. 4:4 WITH 2 Tim. 2:12; Dan. 7:22; Rev. 20:4
        iv. **Priests**- Rev. 5:8-10 WITH Rev. 1:5-6; 1 Pet. 2:5, 9
        v. **Kings**- Rev. 5:8-10 WITH Rev. 1:6; 2:12
        vi. **Worshipping God**- Rev. 4:10-11; 5:14
        vii. **In heaven at the rapture and thereafter**- Rev. 4:1-2 WITH 1 Thess. 4:16-17; 1 Cor. 15
            1. These are all things that apply to saints/believers of the church age
    b. The **apostles** are referred to/connected with "elder" 11x (Acts 15:2, 4, 6, 22, 23; 16:4; 21:18; 1 Pet. 5:1; 2 Jn. 1:1; 3 Jn. 1:1
    c. The 12 sons of Jacob (Israel) could be seen as the foundation of all Old Testament saints (representative of them all)- Acts 7:8-9
    d. We see this distinction and place of prominence for these groups in the future perfect kingdom- Rev. 21:12, 14
        i. It would make sense that the 12 sons of Jacob who are the fathers of all of the tribes of Israel would represent all OT saints and that the 12 apostles would represent all NT saints (Eph. 2:20)
    e. Normally, we would take the passage literally and not read into it what it does not say; however, Revelation 5:8-9 give us a reason to think they represent more than just 24 saints
        i. Their song of redemption through the blood of Christ and the fact that they come from EVERY KINDRED, EVERY TONGUE, EVERY PEOPLE, AND EVERY NATION; says that they must represent a much larger group than these 24 alone
        ii. Also because every aspect of them aligns with things that are said of the church and OT saints

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            2. ALSO- Ezekiel 1:11, 23

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1. ***What/who is a leviathan and why is it a thing?***
    a. To begin, let's look at some theories out there as to who this creature is
    b. Job 41- The great chapter on this creature- CONSIDER THE CONTEXT FIRST
        i. In the first chapters of the book we are shown a great spiritual battle going on over the life of Job, then suddenly we are shown the events on earth in his life as a result of this: Bad things happen to him, he complains, his friends convince him he must have done something wrong to deserve it (using all sorts of "biblical reasoning"), to the point Job wants to die, and then God begins to rebuke and teach him near the end of the book (chapter 41) about what is REALLY going on (he became convinced that he must have done something to deserve this).
        ii. The very sight of him causes people to fall (vs 9)
        iii. Nobody can stand against him (vs 10)
        iv. He is proud (vs. 15)
        v. He breathes fire (vs. 21)
        vi. The sorrow of others is joy to him (vs. 22)
        vii. He is hard hearted (vs. 24)
        viii. He is extremely strong (vs. 26-30)
        ix. There is nobody else like him who has no fear (vs. 33)
        x. He is the king over all the children of pride (vs 34)
    c. Other passages- Psa 74:14; 104: 26; Isa. 27:1
        i. Combining this all: He is a multi-headed fire breathing dragon, who will be killed on "that day", he is a serpent, he is the ultimate image of pride, he is ultimately strong, hard hearted, proud, no other creation is like him, he loves the sorrow of others, and he is a king
    d. Connect the multi-headed, serpent/**dragon** with Rev. 12:3, 9
        i. This is none other than the Devil himself!
        ii. God was showing Job the true power behind his suffering! It was not his sin, it was not something he did wrong, it was Satan who was taking everything from him to see if he would turn on God. God was revealing this to Job in GREAT detail.
        iii. Job teaches us some of the most information on the devil that we have
    e. Devotional- Hearing the right voices
        i. Even the most well intentioned, bible quoting people, can be under influence at any given moment by the enemy (Matt. 16:23)
            1. Get advice from a multitude of counselors, BUT always weight what they say against the word of God (it is your final authority)
        ii. Have a growing, thriving, relationship with God through his word. This is the only way to truly 100% have understanding about issues in your life
2. ***Why do new versions like the NIV take out the fasting parts in some verses (Matthew 17:21)?***
    a. From their own words: *"The verse is not included in the newer Bibles because the older and better manuscripts of Matthew do not include it."*
    b. Is this true? What manuscripts include this verse?
        i. Codex C (5th century)
        ii. Codex D (5th century)
        iii. Codex K (9th century)
        iv. Codex L (8th century)
        v. Majority of Byzantine manuscripts
        vi. Other early quotes
    c. If this is not true, then why do they REALLY do it?

i. There is an **enemy** that is behind the changing of God's word since the beginning (Gen. 3:1-6)
ii. God specifically warns about people that would add to, subtract from, and change his word (Deut. 4:2; 12:32; Prov. 30:5-6; Jer. 26:2; Rev. 22:18-19; 2 Thess. 2:2)
    1. To not believe that this is still the way that the devil is trying to attack God's people is simply ignorant of biblical truth and ignorant of the enemy (as we saw with leviathan)
    2. It is not simply about "seeking to take all of the manuscripts and examine and take the best parts of them all to create the "best we can get". It is about a biblical understanding of the manuscripts, where they came from, what they teach, and using this BIBLICAL information to find your ultimate final authority"
iii. This is ultimately done in order to take away bible truth that God wants you to have
    1. Here in Matthew 17:21, it is about not understanding the power of prayer and fasting together for some circumstances that simply need it (to rid people of devils in this context)
        a. There are other places where "fasting" is taken out of verses but prayer is kept (Mark 9:29; 1 Cor. 7:5). The reasoning they give is the same, the answer is the same, and the ultimate attack of the enemy is the same: to HIDE FROM PEOPLE THE POWER OF PRAYER AND FASTING TOGETHER OVER ISSUES THAT PRAYER ALONE CANNOT SOLVE
    2. In 1 John 5:7, it is to take away the greatest verse in your bible about the trinity and Jesus Christ's deity
    3. In Mark 16, they take out the last 11 verses of this gospel, with such verses as "And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature." And the record of Jesus ascension. (nothing important)
    4. In Isaiah 14, they replace the very name of the Devil from before his fall, to conceal his name, identity, and what he was doing and when he fell (Lucifer only shows up in the KJV and NKJV)

3. What would biblical fasting be?

a. **What is fasting**- Fasting simply means: not to eat; to abstain from food; to abstain from nourishment. Jesus referred to not eating as fasting – Matthew 15:32; Mark 8:3
b. **Biblical fasting**- A biblical fast is a periodic, deliberate, voluntary, abstinence from food in order to accomplish a **special** God- directed, spiritual purpose.
    i. It can be done in times of grief, sickness, death, danger, anguish, etc.. – 2 Sam. 12:6; 1 Sam. 31:13; 2 Chron. 20:3; 2 Kings 25:1
    ii. Jesus promoted fasting- Mt. 4:1-2; 9:14-15; 17:14-21; Mk. 9:29
    iii. The early church practiced fasting- Acts 13:1-3
    iv. Paul fasted- 2 Cor. 6:4-5; 11:27
        1. It was used by all of these for things that were very serious: sins that could not be shaken, devils that could not be cast out, missionary journeys/seeking God and where he wanted them to go, Jesus just beginning his public ministry, and many very serious things
        2. Is there something in your life you have prayed and prayed about, sought counsel over, read about in the word, and done all you can to handle it (anxiety, sin, grief, sorrow, etc.) HAVE YOU FASTED OVER IT? Sometimes this is the extra needed to see God move in big ways.
c. What it is NOT- It is not something to do to earn extra favor with God, some higher spiritual attainment, or monkish lifestyle to show your commitment
    i. Some view fasting as a way to earn extra favor with God or as a religious thing we can do to get God to do what we want
    ii. It is simply saying no to your flesh and saying you desire to be full spiritually more than you are physically. When we do this, we walk in the spirit and not the flesh and we seek a closer communion with God through it
    iii. The fasting itself does not get you closer to God, it is about the heart desire to be closer to him and give up anything else that gets in the way



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    b. Job 41- The great chapter on this creature- CONSIDER THE CONTEXT FIRST
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   i. There is an /_____ that is behind the changing of God's word since the beginning (Gen. 3:1-6)
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   iii. This is ultimately done in order to take away bible truth that God wants you to have
      1. Matthew 17:21 (fasting); 1 John 5:7 (Jesus Deity); Mark 16 (the gospel/ascension); Isaiah 14 (ID of the Devil)

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c. What it is NOT- It is not something to do to earn extra favor with God, some higher spiritual attainment, or monkish lifestyle to show your commitment

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT

1. ***What is the point of a new and old testament? Why not just the old? Why not just the new?***
    a. Why not just the OT? – Because the Old Testament gives the law and promises but not their **fulfillment**, which comes only through Jesus Christ in the New Testament (Hebrews 10:1; Galatians 3:24)
        1. All "dispensations" (how God deals with mankind during certain times) were offered to man as genuine offers (don't eat of this tree and you will live in peace with me; keep these laws and live in this orderly way and love me and you will be a great kingdom and be blessed; etc..)
        2. However, God KNEW that mankind would not obey him long-term under ANY of these systems; so he continued to use new ones; the OT was never a long-term solution
        3. As these were not kept, mankind is proving themselves that without God dealing with sin in the universe, they could never be at peace with him
        4. Even when God dies for everyone, giving his own life, giving his Spirit to live in those who trust in him, giving them his written/perfect word; with sinners still in the world, the devil still at work, and sin not FULLY DEALT WITH; this will still not work
        5. God didn't send Jesus right after Adam fell because man had to first see that he couldn't save himself—by conscience, law, religion, or even signs and wonders. The history of the Old Testament proves this.
        6. Even the history of the NT proves this. With believers who are given the righteousness of Christ and their sins fully forgiven, he still will have to come back and set things right on this earth and give us glorified bodies in order to fulfill his promises because we as the church of God; the body of Christ, will fail in our mission.
        7. God dealt with man in different ways in different ages so as to demonstrate the failure of man under every test.
        8. That is why the judgment of God is so important: there has to come a day where God draws a line in the sand and says you are either with me (you chose me) or against me. If you have not chosen him but have chosen sin; he HAS TO JUDGE you in order to eventual rid the universe of sin, death, sorrow, etc..
    ii. The OT was a shadow of the ultimate fulfillment of the NT; it was genuinely offered as a way for peace/government/dealing with sin in the world, but was never going to work because of human nature
        1. It also showed the inability of man to do this on his own without ultimate judgment of sin
    b. Why not just the NT?- Because the New Testament reveals Christ, but you can't understand who He is or why He came without the Old Testament's prophecies, types, and foundation (Luke 24:27; Romans 15:4)
        i. The Bible says there was a right time for Jesus to come- **Galatians 4:4-** *"But when the fulness of the time was come, God sent forth his Son…"*
            1. This means that it was in the plan of God to do this all along (knowing man would not obey his commandments) at the right time
        ii. Again, the question being asked here is basically "Why didn't Jesus just come right away in Genesis after Adam and Eve sinned?" – To show man they could not do it on their own without God. God needed to intervene and deal with sin in the universe. It was the right/just way to do it. – Eph. 2:8-9
2. ***When someone falls away, is there a way to still tell if they are truly saved?***
    a. Yes there is- but how?
        i. Fruit? (Mt. 7:15-23; 13:1-8, 18-23)
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                    i. But these are all part of the sanctification of the life of the believer as they WALK IN THE SPIRIT and grow in their relationship with God, NOT guarantees for anyone who is saved

2. Look at these examples of "saved" people in the bible:
    a. **Lot**- chose Sodom, offered daughters, drunk, incest; CALLED JUST- 2 Pet. 2:7-8
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ii. Profession of faith? (Rom. 10:9-10; 1 Jn. 5:13; John 3:16)
1. The only **TRUE** test to tell if someone is truly saved, is what they have professed about WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS IS NECESSARY FOR SALVATION
    a. RELIGION, wants to slowly and surely add "works" as proof of salvation
    b. We are saved to good works and for good works BUT NOT BY good works
    c. Is someone saved? Did they confess that they believed and received the gift of God which is Jesus Christ's death and resurrection? If they received it, they are saved. (Jn. 1:12)
    d. "Well yeah but… you should….. their life should look…." RELIGION!
    e. It is not that you make salvation cheap, you make it what the Bible says it is. A gift, a gift you receive through faith. There is no other sure way to KNOW if someone is saved, other than what they profess about their belief in Christ for salvation
    f. VIDEOS OF SALVATION STATEMENTS
    g. Only God can judge hearts, if someone says that they prayed to received Christ alone, they have done all a person can do to be saved; this is the greatest evidence of salvation

3. What REALLY happened before the NT started when God wasn't talking back to the people for the dark ages (*400 years of silence)*?

a. The last book of the OT was Malachi. Then there were 400 years where there was no prophet and no inspired writing from God (Amos 8:11)
b. It is **CRUCIAL** to understand that during these years, there was NO NEW SCRIPTURE being written, no new inspiration/revelation from God through the prophets (Mal. 4:5-6; Luke 1:17; Matt. 11:14)
    i. False religions hold to books that are known as the "Apocrypha", all of which were written during this time- Tobit (200 BC); Judith (150 BC); Wisdom of Solomon (50 BC); Sirach (180 BC); Baruch (100 BC); 1 and 2 Maccabees (100-150 BC); etc….
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c. Other attacks/influences from the devil during this time
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    iii. Others- The "Septuagint" (supposed Greek translation of the Hebrew bible); Oral Jewish traditions began (later the "Mishnah", expanded bible meaning beyond the Torah)
d. World power shifts- Persia (539-331 BC); Greece (331-167 BC); Rome (63 BC)
    i. Just as Daniel prophesied in Daniel 2, 7, and 8 the kingdoms preceding his first coming; so John prophesied the kingdoms directly preceding his second coming
    ii. The world was in a flurry of changes during the years of silence; during the time of a "famine of the word of God" preceding Christ's first coming
    iii. The world in in a flurry of changes during these years of "famine of the word of God" preceding Christ's second coming (wars and rumors of wars- Britain, Russia, USA)
    iv. Let this be a reminder to us that where the word of God is not being preached, where there is a famine like this, things get crazy FAST! (Prov. 29:18)

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT

1. ***What is the point of a new and old testament? Why not just the old? Why not just the new?***
    a. Why not just the OT? – Because the Old Testament gives the law and promises but not their _____, which comes only through Jesus Christ in the New Testament (Hebrews 10:1; Galatians 3:24)
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1. ***How does the holy spirit intercede our prayers, like what does he do? What does he make them sound like?***
    a. Key Passage: Romans 8:26-27
        i. This seems to say that when we pray, because we don't pray as we ought to always, the spirit of God intercedes on our behalf to align it with the will of God
        ii. Some may say that our prayers are guided by the spirit and that is all that is meant here, but if that was the case, we would hear the "groanings", but the passage tells us clearly that we don't hear them and they "cannot be uttered". Therefore it cannot be the prayer/words you are praying.
    b. The whole **trinity** is involved in our prayers:
        i. We pray to the Father- Mt. 6:9; Eph. 3:14
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        i. There is such power in prayer that too often is untapped by us simply because we do not pray or we do not pray as often as we ought to. Read and meditate on these promises associated with prayer and let it change how you pray!
            1. For wisdom (James 1:5-7); for God to move (James 5:16; Matt. 7:7-8); for peace (Phil. 4:6-7); to be heard of God (1 John 5:14-15)
2. **If the king James was written so long ago, how do we know none of the writing got altered and how do we know that none of the disciples put their own opinions instead of what God told them to?**
    a. The King James Version has not been altered since 1611. We still have original copies of it and we can easily see that is has not been altered/corrupted since 1611 when it was written
        i. Changes from KJV editions since 1611:
            1. **Spelling**, Typos, Letter/Font Changes, etc…

1611 Letter/Form	Modern KJV Letter	Example (1611)	Modern Spelling	Notes
"u" used where we now use **"v"**	**"v"**	"vnto"	"unto"	"u" and "v" were interchangeable
"v" used where we now use **"u"**	**"u"**	"haue"	"have"	Common 1611 reversal
"i" used where we now use **"j"**	**"j"**	"Iesus," "Iudah"	"Jesus," "Judah"	"J" did not exist as a separate letter
"ſ" (long s) used like an "f"	**"s"**	"ſaid," "bleſſed"	"said," "blessed"	Visual style only—**not an "f"**
"vv" or "w" used for **"w"**	**"w"**	"vvicked," "vve"	"wicked," "we"	Typesetters used "vv" to form "w"
Archaic spellings	**Modern spelling**	"moe," "musick," "publique," "bloud"	"more," "music," "public," "blood"	Spelling conventions changed

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Extra “e” at the end	**Dropped**	“olde,” “feare,” “nameſe”	“old,” “fear,” “names”	Silent “e” was more common
Compound words spaced	**Compound words joined**	“thy selfe,” “to day”	“thyself,” “today”	Grammar modernized

2. **Ultimately these are not “changes” to the preserved words of God, they are the same words; sometimes they look different or are spelled different, but are the same English words!**

b. By Faith, we believe that God alone inspired, purified, and preserved his words for us
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c. The content of the Bible testifies that it is not some manmade document of conjured up stories, but the very word of God
   i. Fulfilled **Prophecy** (Only God can predict the future):
      1. Isaiah 44:28; 45:1 – Names Cyrus 150 years before birth; Micah 5:2 – Predicts Christ’s birth in Bethlehem; Daniel 9:25–26 – Predicts Messiah’s exact time of death; Psalm 22, Isaiah 53 – Foretells Christ’s crucifixion before crucifixion even existed
   ii. Doctrinal and Structural Unity:
      1. Written by 40+ authors from all walks of life (kings, shepherds, fisherman, doctors) across 1,500 years, 3 languages, 3 continents, and yet tells one unified story
      2. All point to one Savior, one God, one redemptive plan
   iii. Honest Reporting (No man writes this way):
      1. Shows flaws of its own heroes: David’s sin, Peter’s denial, Moses’ failure
      2. Man-made books glorify man. The Bible humbles man and glorifies God
   iv. Scientific and Historical Accuracy:
      1. Isaiah 40:22 – The earth is round; Psalm 8:8 – Describes ocean currents; Leviticus 17:11 – Life is in the blood; Archaeological discoveries continue to confirm Scripture, not disprove it
   v. Power to Transform Lives:
      1. No book has saved more souls, healed more families, or transformed more nations
   vi. Claims to be God’s Word:
      1. 2 Tim. 3:16 – “All scripture is given by inspiration of God”
      2. 1 Thess. 2:13 – “…ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, the word of God”

3. **If all the other versions, except KJV, are wrong why do people still preach and talk with them?**
   a. The word of God has been under the same attack since the very **beginning**- Gen. 3:1-5
   b. The enemy of God has been countering the working of God since the very beginning- Genesis 1:28; 2:16–17; 3:1–7, 15, 21; 4:3–5; 6:1–9; 10:8–10; 11; 13:10–11; 18:17–19; 25:29–33
      i. The BIBLICAL evidence for why we use the King James Bible, and why we believe it is the pure word of God, as opposed to the other versions out there, is not the thing we are proving today. However, we believe based on the evidence that the pure word of God exists and also the changed and perverted word of the Devil exists, since we see both in play from the very beginning

ii. The purpose of the ever so slightly changed word of the devil is to cause death, separation from God, and to promote his kingdom, gospel, seed, king, etc.. NOT God's
iii. Genesis 3:1-5 example

c. There are different groups in this issue
   i. MOST people are ignorant of this issue, they are told it is about "readability" or "older and better manuscripts". These things are not true however.
   ii. Some are being used due to a lack of knowledge (Hosea 4:6)
   iii. Some are in fact being used of the devil to teach and seduce people into doctrines of devils (2 Cor. 11:13-15; 2 Pet. 2:1-3; 1 Tim. 4:1-2; Rev. 2:20)
      1. Specifically, the bibles, doctrines, kingdoms, etc.. all run back to ONE "anti-religious" system, to support it and its doctrines- The Roman Catholic Church (Vaticanus, doctrines such as purgatory, baptism of infants, prayers to mary/mother goddesses, etc..)
         a. Rev. 2:20- Chart

d. Different bibles say different things, teach different things, and ultimately lead to different results (like they did for Adam and Eve) and THERE IS AN ENEMY who has been at work since the very beginning to trick people by slightly changing God's word, to bring death to many

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   ii. Doctrinal and Structural Unity:
      1. Written by 40+ authors from all walks of life (kings, shepherds, fisherman, doctors) across 1,500 years, 3 languages, 3 continents, and yet tells one unified story
      2. All point to one Savior, one God, one redemptive plan
   iii. Honest Reporting (No man writes this way):
      1. Shows flaws of its own heroes: David's sin, Peter's denial, Moses' failure
      2. Man-made books glorify man. The Bible humbles man and glorifies God
   iv. Scientific and Historical Accuracy:
      1. Isaiah 40:22 – The earth is round; Psalm 8:8 – Describes ocean currents; Leviticus 17:11 – Life is in the blood; Archaeological discoveries continue to confirm Scripture, not disprove it
   v. Power to Transform Lives:
      1. No book has saved more souls, healed more families, or transformed more nations
   vi. Claims to be God's Word:
      1. 2 Tim. 3:16 – "All scripture is given by inspiration of God"
      2. 1 Thess. 2:13 – "…ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, the word of God"

3. **If all the other versions, except KJV, are wrong why do people still preach and talk with them?**
   a. The word of God has been under the same attack since the very _____- Gen. 3:1-5
   b. The enemy of God has been countering the working of God since the very beginning- Genesis 1:28; 2:16–17; 3:1–7, 15, 21; 4:3–5; 6:1–9; 10:8–10; 11; 13:10–11; 18:17–19; 25:29–33
      i. The purpose of the ever so slightly changed word of the devil is to cause death, separation from God, and to promote his kingdom, gospel, seed, king, etc.. NOT God's
      ii. Genesis 3:1-5 example
   c. There are different groups in this issue
      i. MOST people are ignorant of this issue, they are told it is about "readability" or "older and better manuscripts". These things are not true however.
      ii. Some are being used due to a lack of knowledge (Hosea 4:6)
      iii. Some are in fact being used of the devil to teach and seduce people into doctrines of devils (2 Cor. 11:13-15; 2 Pet. 2:1-3; 1 Tim. 4:1-2; Rev. 2:20)
         a. Rev. 2:20- Chart
   d. Different bibles say different things, teach different things, and ultimately lead to different results (like they did for Adam and Eve) and THERE IS AN ENEMY who has been at work since the very beginning to trick people by slightly changing God's word, to bring death to many

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

How did they determine when time actually began, the time we know now?

a. Time in the absolute/linear sense, began in Genesis 1:1 "In the ***beginning*** God created the heaven and the earth."
   i. God is outside of time because he created it (Psa. 90:2; 2 Pet. 3:8)
   ii. We are inside of time, we can only see where we are at and where we have been; but not into the future (unless it is from supernatural, God given prophesy)

b. Time how we **measure** it today (calendrical/cyclical) was established in Genesis 1:14-18
   i. Measuring seasons, times, days, hours, etc.. all began with the institution of it by God in these verses. These are not "man-made" constructs but in fact follow the time set by God
      1. Hours- while the division into 24 hours was more culturally defined later, daylight hours were naturally divided by the sun's movement across the sky
         a. In Jesus' time, people referred to the "third hour," "sixth hour," "ninth hour," based on the sun's position.- John 11:9
      2. Days- one full rotation of the earth on its axis
      3. Months- following the phases of the moon (about 29.5 days)
      4. Years- one full orbit of the earth around the sun (about 365 days)

c. The Storybook Illustration
   i. Absolute time- The book, the story, and the flow of it all is time itself. One day the author decided to start writing a book, he controlled the story but was not "inside of the book/story"
   ii. Calendrical/cyclical time- The paragraphs are days, the pages are months, the chapters are years, etc.. This is how the book time/length is measured
   iii. We are in the story as characters; we can look back and live up to the current page we are on but we cannot see the whole story from beginning to end; only the author knows that (outside of the book/writing the book)
      1. It is not a perfect illustration but it works for our purposes today

2. Why do priests bless houses?

a. This is a Catholic practice known as a "***sacramental***"- **CCC 1667** – "Sacramentals are sacred signs which bear a resemblance to the sacraments. They signify effects, particularly of a spiritual nature, which are obtained through the intercession of the Church."
   i. These have been practiced for years usually around January 6th (Ephiphany) remembering the visit of the Magi to the house where Jesus was (cf. *Matthew 2:11*)

ii. They typically involve: prayer by a priest over the home, sprinkling of holy water, and writing with chalk above the door "May Christ Bless this Home"

iii. The reasons for this being done are many but could include: moving into a new home, for peace/protection, inviting an extra blessing from God to the home, as a witness that the home worships Christ, etc..

1. The issue is: THIS IS NOT BASED ON SCRIPTURE BUT RATHER TRADITION
2. Traditions that have roots in pagan Roman, Egyptian, Grecian, Europian, etc… practices

b. Conclusion: Unfortunately, as it is with many Roman Catholic practices, this is NOT a biblical practice but rather **tradition** of the Catholic church which they first took from multiple pagan practices. Blessing of houses in this way looks more like false pagan rituals than ANYTHING you find the New Testament church doing in the Bible (Mk. 7:7-13; Col. 2:8; Mt. 15:3,6; Titus 1:14)

3. ***How would you go about not being hopeless knowing you'll probably never live past a certain age because everyone is saying the world is ending and all the pieces are falling into place? I've been told that the same things were said when my parents were young, but what if it really is different now?***

i. While I understand the question from a human perspective, the Bible does give us clear answers on this

b. First; the signs are absolutely there…Unlike ever before- The signs of: **ISRAEL**, wars, global alignments/currencies, apostacy, homosexuality, rise of the Catholic Church and its alignments with other major religions, Laodicea and its relation to church history, technology booms, increase in natural disasters, constant calls for peace in the middle east, 7,000 years of human history, order of 2 Chron-Psalms doctrinally, etc…

c. These words are supposed to "comfort" us and bring us hope!- 1 Thess. 4:13-18; 5:27

d. These words are supposed to bring us closer together- Heb. 10:25

e. We can receive a crown for having the right heart/perspective on Jesus coming back- 2 Tim. 4:7-8

f. When we don't look forward to his coming, it may be a sign that our priorities/values are out of order- Col. 3:1-5

i. We may be valuing earthly things too much- vs 1-2

ii. This causes us to not look forward to his appearing- vs 3-4

iii. This is usually accompanied by living in the flesh and after the ways of the world- vs 5

g. We need to have eternal perspective- 2 Cor. 4:18

h. We don't belong to this world and we should feel like strangers in it- Phili. 3:20; Heb. 11:13-16

i. When we see Jesus and we enter into glory, we won't give a second thought to the cares of this world- Psa. 16:11; Rev. 21:4; Isa. 65:17

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